Welcome to the LVNA

Villager

The Newsletter of the Lakewood Village Neighborhood Association

Lakewood Village Neighborhood Association

Lakewood Village, Sunnyvale, California

May, 2002

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To subscribe to the Lakewood Village mailing list, send a blank email to: lakewoodvillage-subscribe@topica.com

Next LVNA Meeting:

Wednesday, May 8th, 7:00 pm, *Lakewood Park Building*

Magkakaroon po nang pagpupulong ang LVNA
sa 8 Mayo, 2002, 7:00 pm sa Lakewood Park Building

Proxima junta de LVNA sera efectuada
el 8 Mayo, 2002 a las 7:00 pm en el Lakewood Park Building

Election results for the 2002-2003 LVNA Board

- Craig Crawford, LVNA President

The elections for the new LVNA board were held last month. Here are the results:

President: Craig Crawford
1st Vice President: Sarah Daughtery
2nd Vice President: Elena Anderson
Secretary: Tom Freeman
Treasurer: Scott Lewis

I want to take this time to thank Bob Lacy for his outstanding work as past treasurer. Bob has been a tireless volunteer for several years. His treasury skills have resulted in balanced books and timely reports to the Board and the membership. Bob is active in his church and is a member of the choir. Thank you, Bob, for your outstanding volunteer work! Let me introduce our new board members:

Sarah Daugherty, our new 1st Vice President, has been a long time Lakewood Village resident. She has been a walker of the newsletter for several years and enjoys the people that she knows on her route. Sarah has grown children that also live in Lakewood and they are also long time Lakewood volunteers. Welcome, Sarah, to the LVNA board. Your knowledge of Lakewood and a keen ►► ► understanding of our strengths and weakness will give the LVNA a voice that will make a difference.

Scott Lewis, out new treasurer, came to the meeting on the night of the election and volunteered to take the treasurers position. Bob agreed to withdraw from the election and let Scott take his place on the ballot. Scott, a California native, has not lived in Lakewood for a long time, but he has come to love the Village and its people. Scott wants to give back to the community. He has volunteered to be the "New Advertising Coordinator" for getting new advertising for the newsletter as well as being the LVNA Treasurer. If you are interested in becoming an advertiser in the LVNA newsletter, please get in contact with Scott and he will explain how to become a new advertiser in the greatest newsletter in Sunnyvale.■

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President's Column

- Craig Crawford
President, LVNA

As we enter into spring, our focus turns to the outdoors and fresh air. Take this time to look at your yard and house, and set your priorities for repairs and maintenance. For me, I want to pressure-wash the outside of my house and touch up the paint where it is showing it's age. This should only take a weekend or so, and it will make everything look bright and fresh. We used to call this spring-cleaning, but his tradition has all but been lost in our instant gratification society. I remember my great grandmother pulling the furniture and rugs out of each room and washing everything down. I wish I had the energy to do this, but I must confess that I don't. Set a goal this spring to tackle one improvement project to make your place look good, after you finish, step back and admire your work and a smile will cross your face for a job well done.

I made a bicycle ride around Lakewood last week to admire the flowers and shrubs that are blooming, and I have good news to report. I only saw a few garbage cans left out in the front of Lakewood homes (which violates city code). What a change from two months ago when two streets had forty houses with garbage cans left out. Is it that people care more, or is it the threat of getting a citation? I don't know, but I want to believe that people are starting to care more. Congratulations to all of Lakewood for a job well done! ■



Newsletter Walkers Needed

- Elena Anderson

Your LVNA is in need of a few good folks to help get the message out. It takes only a few minutes a month, gets you out of the house into the fresh air, and gives you an opportunity to meet some of your neighbors. If you can devote some time as a Newsletter Walker, please call Elena at 745-6028. It's a great way to make a contribution to the Neighborhood! ■



From the Editor's Desk

- Editor

As always, I'm looking for new sources of articles for the Villager. If you have any urge to write an article, please do! Or, if you have any suggestions for articles to be written by others, send them to me as well.

To contact the Editor of the Villager…
Send your articles, comments, and corrections by email to lvna_editor@magicaldesk.com (note that this is a new email address), by FAX to (408)738-2821, or by postal mail to LVNA Villager, c/o Brian Smithson, 1104 Burntwood Court, Sunnyvale CA 94089. ■

LVNA Meeting

- Editor

All residents of Lakewood Village are encouraged to attend this monthly meeting. You will meet some of your neighbors, learn about upcoming events of special interest to our community, have a chance to voice your concerns and opinions, and help work towards a better neighborhood. Children are welcome.

The next meeting is:

Date: Wednesday, May 8th
Time: 7:00 p.m.
Place: Lakewood Park Building ■



May LVNA Meeting Guest Speaker

- Craig Crawford
President, LVNA

For our May meeting, we have a very special guest speaker. Pam Kelly will be talking about Santa Clara County Children's Health Initiative. Santa Clara County is the first county in the nation to commit to providing health coverage for its estimated 71,000 uninsured children. Through a groundbreaking comprehensive health insurance package and aggressive outreach program called the Children's Health Initiative, over 26,000 of those uninsured children have applied for coverage since the program inception on January 2, 2001. And the rate of applications is steadily increasing, showing the great need for children's health insurance in the State's fourth largest county.

The Children's Health Initiative (CHI) reaches out to uninsured children through three health plans: Medi-Cal, Healthy Families, and the new Healthy Kids program, which insures children whose families earn up to 300% of federal poverty level and are not eligible for Medi-Cal and Healthy Families. Healthy Kids is the essential component in helping reach ►► ► the goal of making health insurance accessible to all children in the County.

Eligibility requirements for Healthy Kids are simple, a child must:

- Be 18 years of age or under.
- Live in Santa Clara County.
- Have a family income at or below 300% of the Federal Income Guidelines, For example, a family of four earning up to $54,000 a year can insure each child for only $6 per month.
- Not be eligible for Medi-Cal or Healthy Families.

If you are in need of Health insurance for your children, or you know of someone that has the need for this program, please come to the meeting at 7:00pm on May 8th at the Lakewood Park Building. There is nothing more important than having your children insured. The cost of hospital stays without insurance is enough to lead to financial disaster for all but the wealthiest of us. If you can't make it to the meeting, here are some telephone numbers that can set you up with the people that run this program:

- For enrollment information about Medi-Cal, Healthy Families and Healthy Kids call 1-888-244-56222
- For information about how you can help or to make a donation to Healthy Kids call 408-260-4489 ■

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Sunnyvale Library Bookmobile

- Editor

Fairwood School	2:15 to 3:00 p.m. 5/14, 5/28, 6/11
Lakewood School	2:00 to 3:00 p.m. 5/16, 5/30, 6/13 ■

From the Police Blotter: Lakewood Village and nearby areas

- Courtesy of the Sunnyvale Department of Public Safety



4/13 Oak Creek Way **Auto Burglary** – Suspect entered vehicle and removed the victims property, then fled the scene. Property removed was personal computer, data store box.

4/14 Oak Creek Way **Auto Burglary** – After opening the passenger's side door, the suspect entered the vehicle and removed victim's property, then fled the scene. Property removed was portable CD player and Chevron credit card.

4/14 Tucson Ave. **Under the influence** – No information available

4/23 Fairoaks Ave. **Under the Influence** – Suspect was riding a bicycle with no headlight on sidewalk after dark. Suspect displayed signs of being under the influence and admitted to using crank within the last two hours. Arrested and booked transported to County jail.

4/24 Lawrence Expressway **Prostitution/disorderly conduct** – No information available

4/20 Murphy Park **Carrying an illegal weapon** – Stopped suspect for municipal code violations. While speaking with suspect, a large knife was discovered concealed under his jacket. Suspect was arrested and transported to jail.

4/21 Duane Ave. **Possible controlled substance for sale** – Clerk from Car Spa reported a shoplifting incident in her store. Officer contacted suspect at the gas pumps. Drugs were found on suspect's person and drugs were found for sale in her car. Suspect was arrested and transported to County jail.

Editor's note: As always, if you see suspicious activity or are aware of any crime, no matter how minor it may seem, please report it to Sunnyvale's Department of Public Safety. For emergencies, call 911; for non-emergencies, call 730-7100. ■

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This Month in Lakewood History...

- Brian Smithson

39 years ago: In 1963, the president of the LVRA (predecessor to today's LVNA) proclaimed the month of May to be "Lakewood Beautiful" month. Maybe we should do that again?

39 years ago: Also in 1963, the LVRA's "Lakewood Park Committee" raised enough money to pay for the City to plant larger, more mature trees in Lakewood Park as it was being developed.

35 years ago: In May 1967 a "Miss Lakewood Village" beauty contest was held. Entrants were judged for poise, talent, and beauty. No formalwear was required, but they did need to display themselves in one-piece bathing suits. I'm not kidding about this. Wow, times have changed...

Did you know?

Lakewood Village was built in a series of development stages, and each one was given a "unit" number according to the order in which houses were built in each region. Here they are:

- Unit 1: Sandia Avenue to Wildwood Avenue, east of Lawrence Expressway.
- Unit 2: Lakehaven Drive to Lakewood Drive, west of Lawrence Expressway.
- Unit 3: Lakehaven Drive to Lakebird Drive, west of Lawrence Expressway.
- Unit 4: Palamos Avenue to Sandia Avenue, east of Lawrence Expressway.

Share your history!

Are you a long-time resident of Lakewood Village? Do you have old photographs, real estate brochures, newspaper clippings, or old LVRA/LVNA newsletters sitting in a box in your garage? I'm interested in putting together a year-by-year history of Lakewood Village, and your historical materials would be very helpful. I'd be happy to pick up items, copy them, and return the originals. Call me at 738-5939 or email lvna_editor@magicaldesk.com. ■



Ask The Officer

- Courtesy of the Sunnyvale Department of Public Safety

Bicycle Laws

Q: What is the law regarding wearing bicycle helmets?

A: California state law mandates that anyone under the age of 18 must wear a helmet while riding a bicycle. However, I recommend that everyone riding a bike wear a helmet, it could save your life!

Q: Is it ever legal to drive in a bike lane?

A: It is not legal to drive in a bike lane except to prepare for a turn within a distance of 200' from an intersection, to park where parking is permitted or to enter or leave the roadway.

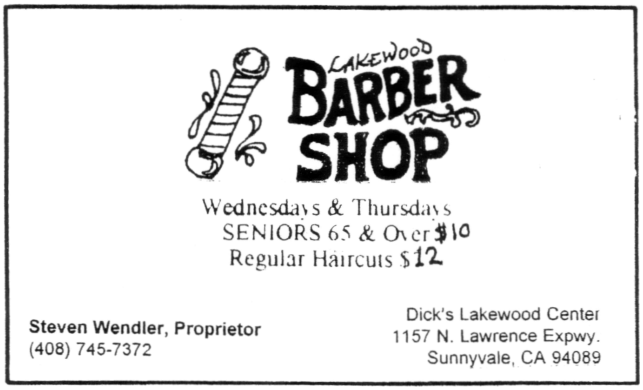
Bike Safety Tips

- Protect your head, wear a helmet.
- Make sure your bicycle is adjusted properly
- Always check brakes before riding
- See and be seen, wear bright colored clothing
- Avoid biking at night but if you must be sure your bike has reflectors and a light, it's the law
- Stay alert. Keep a lookout for obstacles in your path
- Go with the flow. Travel in the same direction as vehicles
- Check for traffic. Always be aware of the traffic around you
- Learn the rules of the road. Obey traffic laws
- Don't flip over your bicycle. Wheels should be securely fastened ►►

► ***Skateboard Laws***

10.12.035 Sunnyvale Municipal Code - Use of skateboard prohibited. It is unlawful for any person to ride on or operate any skateboard or similar device on the roadway portion of any street; nor shall any person in any retail commercial district, ride on or operate any skateboard or similar device on any sidewalk or public or privately owned parking lot.

Though there are no specific laws that say you must wear a helmet while riding a skateboard, we recommend you wear it along with elbow, knee and wrist guards. ■



Fairwood Neighborhood Traffic Study

- Craig Crawford
President, LVNA

Non-neighborhood traffic and traffic congestion at the Lawrence Expressway / Lakehaven - Sandia intersection have been issues for many years. Dating back to the early 1980's, concerns about development in the City of Santa Clara causing traffic impacts in the neighborhood have been discussed and debated. The City of Sunnyvale has considered various roadway improvement and traffic enforcement strategies to address potential problems.

At this time development in the south Great America area of Santa Clara has largely stabilized. The city has conducted a technical assessment of traffic conditions to determine the extent of traffic problems and the need for further improvements. A comprehensive data collection effort has taken place, and various improvement alternatives explored. Alternatives include realignment of Wildwood Avenue at Lawrence Expressway and installation of a new traffic signal, ►►

▶ diversion of neighborhood street traffic and installation of additional traffic controls, road closures, or intersection improvements.

The city has completed a Traffic Study of the Fairwood area (east of Lawrence Expressway and west of Calabazas Creek). The Sunnyvale City Council will consider pros and cons of various alternatives and give staff direction on future traffic improvements in the area at an upcoming City Council Meeting. Public testimony will be taken at this meeting:

May 14 at 7:30
Sunnyvale City Hall
West Conference Room
456 West Olive Avenue

It is important that we fill the City Council Hall with concerned Lakewood Village residents so that our voice is heard and what is best for the Village happens. Please understand the issues before you go to the meeting so that a good debate will take place. Highly informed residents can give good, constructive feedback to the Council so that they will make good decisions. ■



Neighborhood Preservation: Weeds in your Neighborhood

Hello, I'm Richard Gutierrez, your Neighborhood Preservation Specialist. I have been circulating the Lakewood Village area and have observed several properties with overgrown vegetation. Springtime is here and weeds are becoming a problem.

Weeds, when mature, may bear seeds of a downy or wingy nature. These seeds take flight and spread throughout the neighborhood becoming a nuisance for everyone. When weeds and indigenous grasses attain such a large growth they become a health and safety problem. Not only do weeds create a hazard but they also decrease the appearance and the value of your property. The City of Sunnyvale requires residents to remove or destroy weeds from their property.

Sunnyvale Municipal Code 8.20.010(a) states:

> "No owner, agent, lessee or other person occupying or having charge or control of any building, lot or premises within the city shall permit weeds to remain upon the premises, or public sidewalks, or streets, or alleys between the premises and the centerline of any public street or alley."

Please be aware if you are found in violation of the SMC 8.20.010, you may be issued a citation of $50.00 up to $500.00 for each day the violation exists. The weeds may also be declared a public nuisance and can be abated by the City.

In addition to removing the weeds from your property, you can improve the appearance of your home and neighborhood by installing landscaping. There are a number of drought tolerant and low maintenance plants available that could dramatically increase the appearance of your home and neighborhood. Your efforts to improve your property, and keep Sunnyvale looking great, will not only be appreciated by you, but also by your neighbors and the City.

For more information, contact:

Richard Gutierrez
City of Sunnyvale
Neighborhood Preservation Specialist
(408) 730-7447 ■

LVNA Officials

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	iamcraw@earthlink.net	
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Ad Coordinator	Scott Lewis *	245-6206
	lewbiglew@aol.com	

* new official

** new email address

Important Phone Numbers

Public Safety – Emergency		**911**
Public Safety – Non-emergency		**730-7100**
Parks and Maintenance		730-7506
Animal Control		730-7178
Code Enforcement		730-7610
Crime Prevention		730-7140
Hazardous Materials		730-7212
Housing Inspection		730-7610
Lakewood Pool		734-8190
Street Light Repairs		730-7510
Shopping Cart Retrieval		730-7510
NRO	Dave Falletta	730-7148
Vehicle Abatement	Sally Personett	730-7104
Neighborhood Preservation	Rich Gutierrez	730-7447

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City of Sunnyvale	http://www.ci.sunnyvale.ca.us/
State of California	http://www.ca.gov/
Lakewood School	http://www.sesd.org/Schools/Lakewood/index.html
Fairwood School	http://www.sesd.org/Schools/Fairwood/index.html
Coming soon: an LVNA Web Site!	Look for details in an upcoming edition of the Villager

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- Editor

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- Editor

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